

From the Dry Side

The rain never counted as weather to you.
It came down and you went out,
knees in the dirt, hands going
into the wet dark of it,
straightening a stem that had given up,
pressing the soil back around a root
like you were tucking someone in.

I stayed on the verandah where it was dry.
That was my job, apparently –
to watch you from the good chair,
to see the water bead along your sleeve
and you not once look up at the sky
to ask it anything.

And the dog. Always the dog,
three steps behind you the whole afternoon,
sitting when you sat,
moving when you moved,
soaked through and pleased about it,
as though following you were a kind of work
he'd been hired for.

I could have brought you an umbrella.
I don't think you'd have taken it.

I still see the garden that way –
you bent over it, the dog waiting,
the rain doing what rain does,

and me on the verandah,
watching the whole thing happen
and not knowing yet
that I'd want it back.

🔊 WRITTEN FOR MOM